

Membership Plans

Admin guide — how to run it, and what the client sees

This is brand new.

Membership plans did not exist in the dashboard before. It was added as part of this release. Nothing about how you work today breaks: every client we already have keeps their full dashboard exactly as it is. The feature **asks** them to pick a plan, it does not switch anything off.

What it does

Clients can now choose a paid plan for their website from inside the dashboard. The plan they are on decides what they can see and what they can ask us for. You confirm the money, and that is the thing that switches the plan on.

Why we added it

- Every client sits on a **named service level**, so what we owe them is written down instead of remembered.
- Change requests are **counted**, so “just a few small changes” stops quietly becoming unpaid work.
- Hosting-only clients and full-service clients are clearly separated, and the dashboard shows each the right thing.
- Upgrades, renewals and cancellations all leave a record, so nothing depends on one person remembering a phone call.

The three plans

Prices are in USD. They live in one place in the code, so every screen, email and invoice reads the same number. They are not edited from the dashboard.

Plan	Per month	Change requests	What they get
Basic	\$9	None. Self-service.	Hosting and dashboard access. They make their own changes. They can only raise Site down and Billing tickets.
Managed Most popular	\$19	2 a month	Everything in Basic, plus we manage it: software and plugin updates, a monthly health check, and ticket support.
Unlimited Best value	\$29	Unlimited	Everything in Managed, plus priority support, daily backups, 24/7 uptime monitoring, advanced security, ongoing SEO, speed tuning and a monthly report.

Longer commitments cost less

A client picks a plan *and* how long for. The discount is applied automatically — nobody types a price.

Paid for	Discount	Basic	Managed	Unlimited
1 month	—	\$9.00	\$19.00	\$29.00
3 months	10% off	\$24.30	\$51.30	\$78.30
6 months	15% off	\$45.90	\$96.90	\$147.90
12 months	20% off	\$86.40	\$182.40	\$278.40

What the client sees

Worth reading first, because your side of the job only makes sense once you know what happened on theirs.

1 They sign in and are asked to pick a plan

The first time a client logs in without a plan, a window opens showing the three plans side by side, highest first.

It opens **once**. If they close it, it does not come back on its own — a prompt that reappears every login is one people stop reading.

After that, a slim line at the top of their dashboard and a **Plan** link in their menu are how they find it again.

2 They choose a plan and a length

They pick Basic, Managed or Unlimited, then Monthly, 3, 6 or 12 months. The price and the saving update as they switch.

When they confirm, they see: *“We will send payment details to your email shortly. Your perks unlock as soon as payment is confirmed.”*

Nothing unlocks yet. This is the single most important rule in the feature — choosing a plan is not paying for one.

3 They pay, and you confirm it

Covered on the next page. This is your part.

4 Everything they bought unlocks at once

The next time they open the dashboard they get a short “you now have” window.

It lists **only what is new to them**, and each line is a link to the place in the dashboard where that thing actually lives.

For an upgrade it shows just the difference, not the whole plan again.

It is shown once per plan they buy.

5 From then on, their Billing page tells them where they stand

Which plan they are on, what it cost, and the date it renews.

For Managed: a small meter showing **2 of 2 changes left this month** and the day it resets.

Panels for things their plan does not include show up **locked**, so they can see what a higher plan would give them without being nagged about it.

A note on the upgrade prompts

The dashboard will occasionally suggest a higher plan, but it is deliberately kept quiet: never in the first 7 days of a new plan, at most once every 7 days after that, and if a client says “not now” three times in a row the gap stretches to 30 days. “Remind me later” is honoured exactly. You do not need to manage any of this.

Your job, step by step

We take payment by hand — we send details, the money arrives, you confirm it. The dashboard never takes a card. Your whole job lives on one panel.

1 Open Billing and find “Waiting on payment”

Go to **Billing** in your menu. Admins see an extra panel at the top called **Waiting on payment**. Clients never see it.

Every client who has chosen a plan and not paid yet is listed here, newest first.

Each row shows: their name, the plan and length they picked, their email, **how much to ask for**, and the date they chose it.

If it says “*Nobody is waiting on payment details*”, there is nothing to do.

2 Send them the payment details

Each row is tagged **Send payment details**. Send them our bank details for the amount shown on the row.

Use the amount on the row, not the plan's list price. They are different when a client is upgrading, because unused days from their old plan are credited off — the row already shows the credit applied.

Nothing is automated here on purpose. A real person sends the details and a real person confirms the money.

3 When the money lands, press “Mark as paid”

The button is on the client's row. That one press is what starts the plan.

It starts their billing period, retires whatever plan they were on, unlocks everything the new plan includes, and sends their confirmation email.

You will see: “*[Client] is now active. Their perks are unlocked.*”

Only press this once the money is actually in. This is the one step in the whole feature that cannot be undone.

4 If you are a new admin, a second admin signs it off

Confirming a payment on a brand new admin account goes to the other admins first. You will see: “*Sent to the other admins to sign off. Nothing has changed yet.*”

That is not an error. The plan has not started, and no money has been recorded. Another admin approves it from the Approvals page and it runs then.

Once a senior admin marks your account as trusted, you can confirm payments directly.

Pressing it twice is safe

A double click, or a flaky connection retrying, will not charge anyone twice or push their renewal date out by a month. The same goes for the client: picking the same plan twice gives you one row to act on, not two.

When a client changes plan or leaves

Moving up a plan

- The unused days on their current plan are **credited off** the new price, worked out by the day. A client three months into six months of Managed does not pay full price for Unlimited.
- It appears in **Waiting on payment** like any other choice, with the credit already applied. Collect the smaller amount and press **Mark as paid**.
- Until you do, **they stay on the plan they are already paying for**. Nobody is ever between two plans and covered by neither.

Moving down a plan

- A downgrade does **not** start today and there is **nothing to collect now**. The client is told this before they confirm.
- They keep the plan they paid for until that period runs out. The cheaper plan starts after it, so it will **not** be in your list yet — it shows on their Billing page as scheduled.
- On the day their old plan ends it moves into **Waiting on payment** by itself. Collect then and confirm as normal.
- If you try to confirm it early the dashboard stops you and tells you the start date. That is on purpose.

Cancelling

- A client cancels themselves in one step. No form, no retention screen, and the reason is optional.
- It stops the plan **renewing**. Nothing switches off today — they paid for a period and it runs to the end of it, hosting and perks included.
- You and the other admins get an alert and a Slack message, with the reason if they gave one. Somebody should call them.
- They can also ask us to **prepare their website files**, and that request is recorded so it cannot get lost. We prepare the files; we do not migrate the site or set it up elsewhere.

The change-request allowance

The part clients ask about most. The allowance resets on **their own billing day**, not the 1st — somebody who paid on the 20th gets their changes back on the 20th.

Situation	What happens
A Managed client raises their 1st or 2nd change this month	Goes straight through as a normal ticket.
A Managed client raises their 3rd	Not refused. Three choices: pay for the extra (we quote it per job, so no price is named), save it for next month, or upgrade. What they typed is never thrown away.
Any client reports their site is down	Always gets through, on every plan, and never counts against the allowance. Same for billing questions.
A Basic client asks for a change	Basic is hosting only, so they are shown the offer of Managed instead of a closed door.

Things worth knowing

Our existing clients were not touched

Every client who was already in the dashboard keeps their full dashboard, exactly as it was. They are **asked** to pick a plan through the window and the banner, and that is all. Taking a working dashboard away from paying clients in order to sell them something is the wrong order of operations, and it would fill the support queue in an afternoon. Once everyone has been moved onto a plan, we turn the enforcement on — that is a one-line change for the developer, not something to do by hand.

Perks never unlock before you confirm the money

Worth repeating because it is the line the whole feature rests on. A client who has chosen a plan has chosen a plan. They get nothing extra until you press **Mark as paid**.

Emails the system sends on its own

- **Welcome** — once per client, explaining the plans. Never sent twice.
- **Plan confirmed** — when you mark a payment paid. Lists what they now have, what they paid, and the renewal date. Once per plan.
- **Renewal reminder** — 7 days before a 3, 6 or 12 month plan renews. Monthly plans do not get one, because that would be nagging.

You do not send any of these by hand. If our mail server is briefly down the messages queue and go out when it is back — they are not lost.

Quick reference

Question	Answer
Where do I confirm payments?	Billing → Waiting on payment panel. Admins only.
What actually starts a plan?	You pressing Mark as paid . Nothing else.
How much do I ask a client for?	The amount shown on their row. It already has any upgrade credit taken off.
A client picked a cheaper plan and it is not in my list.	Correct. Downgrades start when the period they paid for ends, and appear in your list on that day.
I pressed Mark as paid and it said it went to the other admins.	Your admin account is new. Nothing has changed yet. Another admin signs it off from the Approvals page.
Can I change the prices?	Not from the dashboard. They live in one place in the code so no screen can disagree with another. Ask the developer.
A client says they cannot raise a ticket.	Check their plan. Basic can only file Site down and Billing . Managed may have used both changes this month.
A client's site is down but they are out of changes.	An outage always gets through, on every plan, and never uses an allowance.

If something looks wrong, stop before you press Mark as paid. Everything else in this feature can be corrected. That one step starts a billing period and retires the plan underneath it, so it is the only one worth double-checking.